



Apple logo banned at Sochi

Samsung one of the sponsors of the Sochi Winter Olympics wants the Apple logo to be covered at event venues <http://dgit.in/LjhPhwp>

Bill Nye vs Ken Ham

Watch this viral video of a debate between a Scientist and a Creationist <http://dgit.in/NyeVsHam>

Bazaar

HP ENVY 17 Leap Motion Edition notebook

Massive laptop with a massive price tag

Straightaway, one thing is very clear - the 3.4kg machine is meant as a desktop replacement and lugging it around on a regular basis is definitely not an option. The design and the look of the ENVY 17 is very similar to the ENVY 15 we reviewed recently. HP's design philosophy of minimalism and straight lines continues, with a greater focus on metallic colours. It's very well-built and the materials used seem to be of good quality.

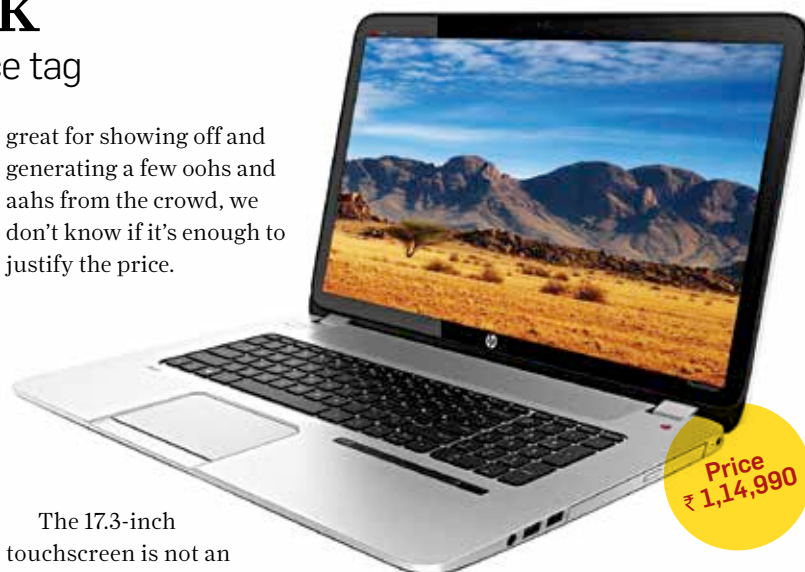
San Francisco based Leap Motion Inc. has been making sensors for PCs and Macs for quite some time now and you can buy them for any existing Windows or Mac machine for just under \$70. The ENVY 17 is the first machine to incorporate that sensor within the device itself. The sensor is seated in what is essentially a strip that sits beneath the keyboard. It uses two cameras and three LEDs to track your hand's movements. This integration is considerably smaller than the standalone version that Leap Motion sells, and is slimmer as well.

We installed the New York Times app from Leap Motion's Airspace Store, just to see how well this feature works, and the experience was rather neat. The detection range is comfortable enough for normal use without worrying about distance. In fact, if the hand gets too close to the sensor, chances are the response will be iffy. Also, the Leap Motion sensor detects ambient light sources and compensates for them. Scrolling horizontally and vertically was very responsive in the New York Times app and it's only when it came to the pointer that we found the response to be iffy, with the pointer getting a bit jittery.

While this in itself is a very cool feature to boast about and show off, you still are limited by the number of apps that are compatible. Leap Motion's AirSpace store has quite a few games, and the typical drawing and painting apps, it's clear that most of Windows' basic tasks are still not compatible with gesture control.

It's obvious that the app has potential and we would most definitely like to see this as a standard feature on laptops of the future but for now, it seems tacked on and isn't as functional as we would like. The limited apps make the function pointless except in a few instances and while it's

great for showing off and generating a few oohs and aahs from the crowd, we don't know if it's enough to justify the price.



The 17.3-inch touchscreen is not an IPS panel as we had hoped and has a resolution of 1080p. The plastic layer in front of the display is much stiffer (thicker, if that word explains it better) than the ones seen on most laptops till date. This massive beast packs in a 4th Generation Intel Core i7-4702MQ clocked at 2.2GHz; Turbo Boost takes it up to 3.2GHz. HP pairs this with 8GB of RAM and a 1TB hard drive. With a top of the line CPU, the ENVY 17 Leap Motion offers blazing performance, as expected.

Gaming performance gets a massive boost with the Nvidia GeForce GT 750M GPU, which manages 60.02 fps in the Cinebench Cinema 4D OpenGL benchmark, which is definitely a good score for a laptop.

Battery life, is a disappointment. While you are not expected to lug this notebook around from meeting to meeting, you do expect some sort of on-the-go capability, when you may urgently require it. This battery lasted just upwards of 60 minutes with the Leap Motion hardware active and waiting for input and 101 minutes with Leap Motion turned off. The large screen also takes a lot of the blame for the low battery life, but if you really do use this as a desktop replacement,

The HP ENVY 17 is an extremely powerful laptop, with top of the line specs with a 17.3" screen capable of 1080p and abysmal battery life. The motion controller is a glimpse of a future that might exist, but for now, it's a little impractical. Buy this if you want great performance or just want to show off some fancy Leap Motion action.

Vishal Mathur



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Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i7-4702MQ @ 2.2GHz; **RAM:** 8GB; **Graphics:** Nvidia GeForce GT 750M (4GB); **Display:** 17.3-inch (1920 x 1080 pixels); **Storage:** 1TB; **OS:** Windows 8.1 (64-bit)

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